

Southern Community Orthopaedic Triage Service (SCOTS)



What to Expect From Your Appointment

WHY HAVE I BEEN REFERRED?

You have been referred to SCOTS Orthopaedic Outpatient Services to assess your musculoskeletal condition (e.g concerns with your joints, muscles, other soft tissues) and determine the best pathway for you.

This may include:

- Advice and education
- A structured rehabilitation plan
- An education program
- Referral to further services (if needed)

WHAT WILL HAPPEN AT MY APPOINTMENT?

We will:

- Listen to your concerns and goals
- Assess your condition
- Review any previous treatment
- Discuss your diagnosis and options

Together, we will agree on a clear plan forward.

WHAT IF I HAVE ALREADY TRIALED PHYSIOTHERAPY?

That is helpful information.

We will look at:

- What type of treatment you have had
- How long you tried it for
- Whether it was targeted and progressive
- Whether it was specifically tailored to your problem

Sometimes a more structured approach can still lead to improvement.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER THE ASSESSMENT?

Depending on your assessment, we may:

- Start or adjust a rehabilitation plan
- Invite you to an education program
- Discharge you with advice
- Refer you for further investigations
- Refer you for a surgical opinion

If a trial of treatment is recommended, we will set a clear timeframe and review your progress.

OUR OBJECTIVES:

- 1) To make sure you receive the right treatment, at the right time, for the best possible outcome.
- 2) Ensure you have access to a comprehensive trial of rehabilitation and education programs to consider their effectiveness.
- 3) Support you by providing strategies you can use to manage your condition by yourself where appropriate.

HOW YOU CAN PREPARE FOR THE ASSESSMENT?

- Bring any relevant scan reports or letters
- Wear comfortable clothing for assessment
- Be ready to discuss how your condition affects your daily life

If you have any questions before seeing us, please speak with your GP or the referring clinician.

We look forward to supporting you. - SCOTS Team.



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About Us

Who we are:

SCOTS as a service is part of the Orthopaedic Outpatient Department Services and is designed to help patients with musculoskeletal conditions access the right care, at the right time, in the right place. We provide assessment and guidance for people experiencing these problems, ensuring that treatment pathways are clear, appropriate, and effective.

Our Role:

SCOTS provides assessment to determine the most appropriate pathway for you. We work closely with GPs, community providers, and Orthopaedic teams to determine whether a patient is best managed with:

- Targeted non-surgical treatment
- Further investigation
- Or referral for orthopaedic (surgical) opinion

Why SCOTS Exists:

Clinical practice guidelines indicate that the gold standard of management for many musculoskeletal/orthopedic conditions (including Osteoarthritis) is a comprehensive targeted, and time appropriate trial of non surgical strategies. SCOTS ensures you have access to these strategies and can trial them appropriately for your condition.

Our Service Locations:

ASSESSMENT CLINICS:

- Te Kaika Wellbeing Hub
- Zingari Richmond Football Club

REHAB PROGRAM SITES:

- Zingari Richmond Football Club Gym

EDUCATION PROGRAM SITES:

- Nutrition Clinic -Otago University
- Chatsford Retirement Village Events Centre

Contact us:

Contact details will be made available after your first appointment with us.

Helpful Links:

Arthritis New Zealand: <https://www.arthritis.org.nz/>

